

Structural and Rhetorical Analysis Grid for Early American Verse

Student handout for tracking form, rhetoric, imagery, and theological shifts in early American verse.

Name: _____ Date: _____ Text / Author: _____

1. Poetic Form & Structure Identify meter, rhyme scheme, stanza patterns, and structural shifts (volta).	2. Rhetorical Modes & Devices Locate ethos, pathos, logos, or extended metaphors (conceits) used by the poet.
3. Diction & Imagery Analysis Track contrast between material/earthly imagery and divine/ascetic vocabulary.	4. Psychological & Theological Shifts Map transitions from grief, fear, or earthly attachment to spiritual resignation.
5. Synthesis & Thematic Conclusion How does the poet balance personal emotion with Puritan theological orthodoxy?	